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7CS076 Project Management L1.4

Credibility, Accuracy, Reliability and Supported

(CARS)

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Learning Outcomes

- By the end of this session, you will be:
  - Aware of the CARS tool
  - Know how to evaluate sources
  - Be able to make critical judgements about sources.

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Critical Reading

- Critical reading involves making judgments about the text
- Do not read looking only for information
- Criticism involves analysing and evaluating
- Criticism does not mean finding fault – criticism can be positive as well as negative
- Whether positive or negative you must be able to articulate your judgement.

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CARS – Analysis Tool

- Your work must be of Academic quality
- Use the CARS system
  - Credibility
  - Accuracy
  - Reliability
  - Support.

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Credibility

- Check for information about the author's education, training and/or experience in the field
- Look for biographical information, the author's title (Dr, Prof etc.)
- Is there evidence of the author’s standing among his peers?
- Look for author’s job (title, position in company etc.)
- Organisational support.

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Accuracy

- Is there a date on the information?
- Is the information up to date or are the ideas/opinions expressed in the article outdated?
- Is the information detailed, exact and comprehensive?
- Check that the intended audience is appropriate.

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Reliability

- Does the article present a balanced argument?
- Is the tone of the writing reasoned?
- How objective is the author?
- Is the work politically biased?
- Is the information believable?
- Is the information consistent?
- Are there conflicts of interest? – eg Bill Gates writing about operating systems.

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Support

- Where did the information come from?
- Are the sources for the information listed?
- Is there a bibliography?
- What support does the author give for the information provided?
- Is contact information provided for the author?